



PAIA Manual

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1. Introduction

This manual is published in terms of section 51 of the Promotion of Access to Information Act, 2 of 2000 ("PAIA"), as amended by the Protection of Personal Information Act, 2013 ("POPIA"). It explains how a member of the public or a Designlynk User can request access to records held by Designlynk (Pty) Ltd ("Designlynk").

2. Contact Details

Designlynk (Pty) Ltd

Information Officer: [To be appointed]

Deputy Information Officer: [To be appointed]

Email: privacy@designlynk.co.za

3. Guide on How to Use PAIA

The South African Human Rights Commission publishes a guide on how to use PAIA, as required by section 10 of the Act. That guide is available from the South African Human Rights Commission and explains the process in more general detail than this manual.

4. Records Available Without a Request

The following records are made available on the Designlynk website or app without the need for a formal PAIA request:

- Terms and Conditions
- Privacy Policy
- This PAIA Manual
- General marketing and informational material about the Platform

5. Categories of Records Held

Designlynk holds the following categories of records, some of which may be requested under PAIA subject to the grounds of refusal set out in the Act:

- User account and profile records
- Engagement records between Clients and Professionals (scope, correspondence, deliverables)
- Financial and payment records processed via Stripe
- Verification and credential records submitted by Professionals
- Internal company records (financial statements, governance records, employment records where applicable)
- Correspondence with regulators, funders, and competition bodies (e.g. Enactus, Ford, MTN)

6. How to Request Access to a Record

A request for access to a record must be made using the prescribed form (Form 2 under the PAIA Regulations), addressed to the Information Officer at the contact details above. The request should describe the record sought in sufficient detail to allow it to be located, and confirm the requester's identity.

Designlynk will respond within 30 days of receiving a valid request, as required by PAIA. If access is refused, reasons will be provided along with information about the right to appeal or apply to the Information Regulator.

7. Fees

A request fee and, where access is granted, a reproduction fee may be payable, calculated in accordance with the fee schedule prescribed under the PAIA Regulations. Current fee amounts are available from the Information Officer on request.

8. Grounds for Refusal

Access to a record may be refused on grounds set out in Chapter 4 of PAIA, including where a record contains another person's personal information, trade secrets, or privileged legal advice, subject to the public interest override where applicable.

9. Complaints and Appeals

A requester who is dissatisfied with a decision may lodge a complaint with the Information Regulator: complaints.IR@justice.gov.za.

10. Availability of This Manual

This manual is available on the Designlynk website/app and may be requested in writing from the Information Officer at no charge.

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